

Piolet is (yet) another P2P file sharing network that Shareaza can work with. Under the Connection link, the bandwidth allocated for upload and downloads can be specified. Under the Download link, the number of active downloads and speed limits for this can be specified. Under the Upload link, upload limits can be specified. The remote access link presents the options to allow the client to be remotely controlled from another PC. The Scheduler allows programming of the client to download at specific times of the day and sets the limits to download. Under the Network link, the different networks to be connected to can be specified, and the connection characteristics tweaked. Since Shareaza cannot create torrents, the external agent to do so can be assigned here. Shareaza comes bundled with a few skins, and these can be applied under the Skins link. The Plugin link displays the plugins already installed in Shareaza, and the behaviour of each can be configured. The Advanced link displays the various options that experts might want to configure.

4.7.4 Comments

Shareaza is the Swiss Army Knife of P2P clients. Those seeking simpler interfaces would be put off by the gaudiness, but the features on offer more than justify the discomfiture.

4.8 DC++

4.8.1 Introduction

This is a client for the Direct Connect P2P protocol. Like eD2K, DC also has hubs that store information about the peers connected to them, and the files shared by each.

4.8.2 Usage

DC++ can be comparatively challenging to use. At first launch, you are presented with a blank window with no messages or Wizard to help out. The first step is to configure the client by visiting the Settings option in the File menu. Once the client has been set up with the bare basics—specifying a nick / username and identifying a share folder—selecting the Public Hubs option under the View menu will bring up the list of DC Hubs available.